

AI Governance Framework Series: An Overview

A Conceptual and Practical Framework for Responsible AI Governance in Higher Education Assessment

Version 1.0

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This overview accompanies the **AI Governance Framework Series** and is intended to support understanding of the conceptual relationships among the seven companion frameworks. It does not constitute institutional policy or regulatory guidance unless formally adopted by the relevant institution.

About this Overview

This document introduces the **AI Governance Framework Series**, a collection of seven complementary frameworks developed to support responsible AI governance in higher education assessment.

Rather than functioning as independent publications, the frameworks are designed as an integrated system. Together they provide conceptual foundations, practical guidance, decision-support tools, and institutional implementation strategies that help educators respond to the educational challenges presented by generative artificial intelligence.

This overview explains the rationale for the series, introduces each framework, illustrates how they relate to one another, and suggests pathways for implementation at institutional, programme, and module levels.

Executive Summary

Generative artificial intelligence has transformed assessment in higher education. Universities increasingly face questions about academic authorship, assessment authenticity, transparency, professional judgement, and institutional responsibility. Although numerous institutional responses have focused on AI detection or academic misconduct procedures, comparatively few provide an integrated educational framework for governing AI-assisted assessment.

The **AI Governance Framework Series** was developed to address this need. Rather than proposing isolated tools or policies, it presents a coherent framework for understanding and implementing responsible AI governance across the assessment lifecycle.

The series consists of seven complementary publications that progress from conceptual foundations to institutional implementation. Together they support educators, programme leaders, quality assurance teams, and institutional leaders in designing assessments that preserve meaningful evidence of student learning while recognising that responsible AI use may legitimately support educational practice.

The series is conceptual and practice-informed. It has not yet undergone formal empirical validation and should therefore be regarded as a foundation for institutional implementation, scholarly discussion, and future research.

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1. Introduction

Generative artificial intelligence has introduced one of the most significant changes to higher education assessment in recent decades. Tasks that traditionally demonstrated independent student learning can now be completed with varying degrees of AI assistance, requiring institutions to reconsider long-established assumptions about academic authorship, assessment validity, and educational integrity.

Although universities have responded in diverse ways, many approaches remain fragmented. AI guidance, assessment design, disclosure requirements, oral verification, moderation, and academic integrity procedures are often developed independently, resulting in inconsistent educational practice.

The AI Governance Framework Series was developed to address this fragmentation by providing a coherent set of complementary frameworks that approach AI governance as an educational system rather than a collection of isolated procedures.

2. Why This Series Was Developed

The series is founded on four observations.

First, discussions about AI frequently focus on technology rather than learning.

Second, assessment integrity is often treated as a reactive compliance issue rather than a continuous educational responsibility.

Third, institutions require practical guidance that extends beyond AI detection or misconduct procedures.

Finally, responsible AI governance requires conceptual clarity together with practical implementation tools.

The seven frameworks were therefore designed to function as an integrated system that supports educational judgement throughout assessment design, implementation, review, and institutional governance.

3. Guiding Philosophy

The framework series is guided by several principles.

- AI governance should support learning rather than simply prevent misconduct.
- Professional judgement remains central to educational decision-making.
- Transparency strengthens trust but does not independently legitimise AI use.
- Assessment should generate credible evidence of authentic learning.
- Institutional governance should be coordinated, proportionate, and continuously improved.

These principles underpin every framework within the series.

4. The Seven Frameworks

Framework	Primary Purpose
1. From Assistance to Authorship	Establishes the conceptual principles for evaluating AI-assisted academic work.
2. AI-Integrated Assessment Integrity Lifecycle	Embeds AI governance throughout assessment planning, design, delivery, evaluation, moderation, and enhancement.
3. AI Disclosure Framework	Provides practical guidance for transparent disclosure of AI assistance.
4. Oral Verification Toolkit	Supports proportionate educational verification of intellectual ownership.
5. Assessment Authenticity Checklist	Helps educators design assessments that preserve meaningful evidence of student learning.
6. AI Risk-Level Matrix	Supports consistent evaluation of the educational significance of AI-assisted work.

Framework	Primary Purpose
7. Institutional AI Governance Guide	Integrates the companion frameworks into a coherent institutional implementation model.

Each framework can be used independently, although their greatest value is realised when implemented together.

5. How the Frameworks Work Together

The seven publications form a progressive governance model.

- **Framework 1** establishes the conceptual foundation.
- **Framework 2** embeds those principles across the assessment lifecycle.
- **Frameworks 3–6** operationalise the conceptual model through disclosure, verification, assessment design, and decision-support.
- **Framework 7** integrates the companion frameworks into institutional policy and practice.

Together they provide a coherent educational approach that moves from theory to implementation without relying exclusively on AI detection or disciplinary procedures.

6. Suggested Implementation Pathway

Institutions need not adopt all seven frameworks simultaneously.

A phased approach is recommended.

Phase 1

Develop conceptual understanding.

- Framework 1
- Framework 2

Phase 2

Strengthen assessment practice.

- Framework 3
- Framework 4
- Framework 5

Phase 3

Support institutional consistency.

- Framework 6
- Framework 7

This sequence allows institutions to develop governance progressively while adapting implementation to local priorities and resources.

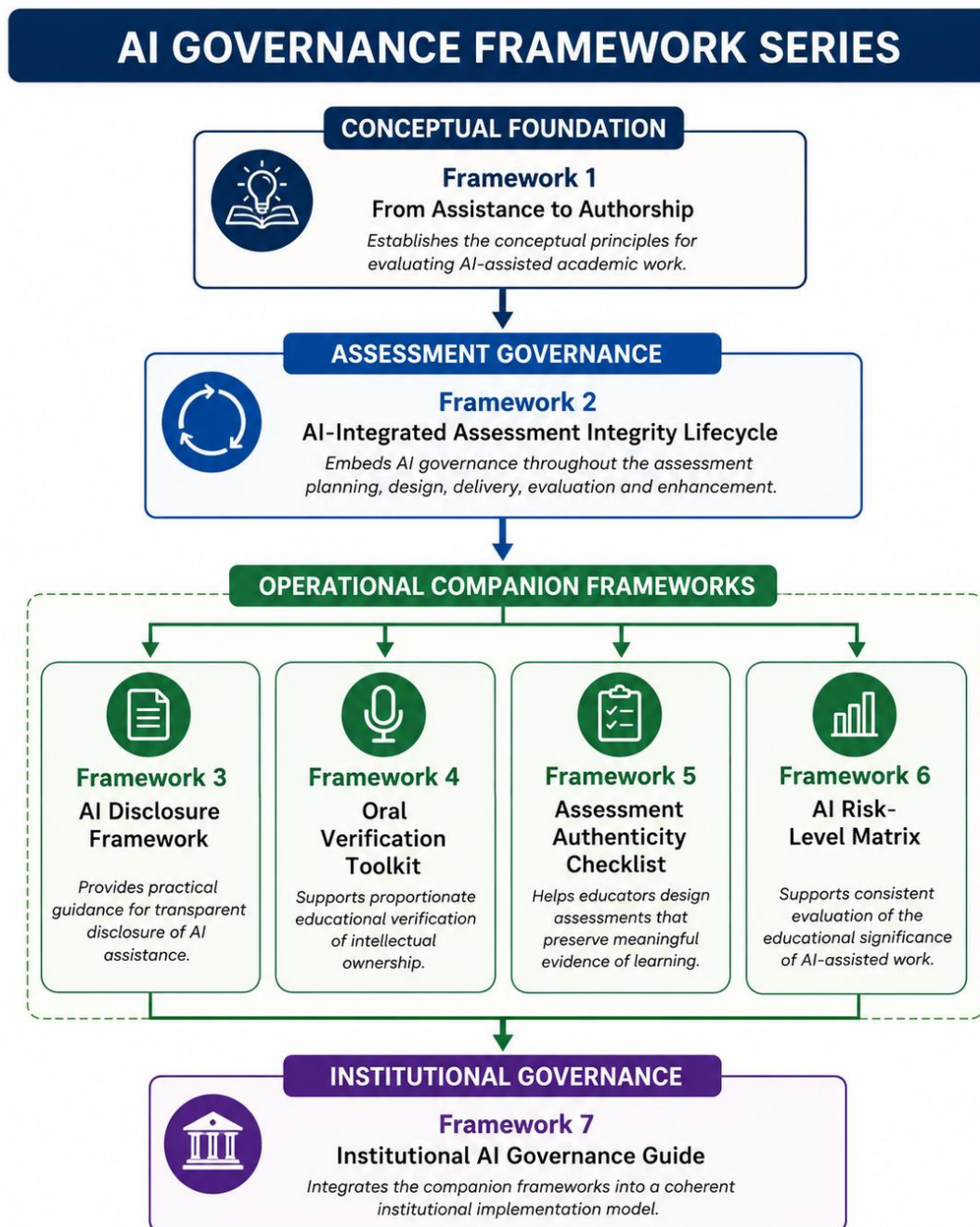
7. Intended Audiences

The framework series has been developed for multiple audiences.

Audience	Most Relevant Frameworks
Lecturers	3, 4, 5, 6
Programme Leaders	2, 5, 6, 7
Assessment Designers	2, 5
Academic Integrity Staff	3, 4, 6
Quality Assurance Teams	2, 6, 7
University Leaders	7
Researchers	1

8. Framework Architecture

Figure 1. AI Governance Framework Series Architecture



Institutional AI Governance Guide

This should become the signature figure for the series.

9. Future Development

The AI Governance Framework Series is intended to evolve through scholarly critique, institutional implementation, and empirical research.

Future development may include:

- empirical validation studies;
 - discipline-specific adaptations;
 - international case studies;
 - institutional implementation reports;
 - revised editions reflecting developments in AI technologies and educational practice.
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10. Conclusion

Responsible AI governance requires more than new technologies or revised academic integrity policies. It requires coherent educational systems that preserve confidence in student learning while recognising that artificial intelligence is becoming an enduring feature of higher education.

The AI Governance Framework Series provides one such system. By integrating conceptual principles with practical implementation guidance, it supports institutions in designing assessments, exercising professional judgement, and developing governance practices that remain educationally meaningful, transparent, and adaptable.

The series should be regarded as a conceptual and practice-informed contribution intended to support institutional implementation, scholarly discussion, and future empirical research.

Version History

Version Date		Description
1.0	July 2026	Initial public release of the AI Governance Framework Series overview.